

London- All Inclusive Guide

Marina Fernandes

Contents

Detailed Itinerary.....	1
Where to Eat in London.....	5
Famous Dishes in England.....	7
Mobile Connectivity while in UK.....	9
Important Numbers in UK.....	9
Embassy Info- UK.....	9
Important Places Around Your Accommodation.....	9
Recommended things to buy/carry.....	10
Recommended Apps.....	10
Regarding Foreign Currency- UK.....	10
Getting Around in London.....	11
What to buy as souvenirs and from where?.....	12
Thank You!.....	12

Detailed Itinerary

Day and Date	Description of activity
Day 1 Dec 28 Saturday	Arrive in London Transfer to your accommodation Spend the day catching up.
Day 2 Dec 29 Sunday	Visit the Buckingham palace (35 mins by public transport) • People usually spend 30 mins unless if you want to view the Change of Guard ceremony • There will be a Change of Guard ceremony on this day at 10:45 am. However, it is advised to arrive latest by 9:30 am to get the best view. • The entire ceremony lasts for 45 minutes Based on the amount of time you have, you can choose to spend time at St. James Park (4 min walk from the Palace) • People usually spend 30 mins here

	Then walk along the Mall to Trafalgar Square (11 min walk from the garden) • People usually spend 15-30 mins • During your visit, the Trafalgar Square Christmas Market will be running • Wander past the wooden chalets filled with handmade crafts, cool gifts and delicious treats • Grab a hot chocolate while listening to carol singers perform festive tunes by the Trafalgar Square Christmas tree. Next, head to Winter Wonderland in Hyde Park • This is one of the biggest Christmas markets in London. • Discover more than 100 wooden cabins. • It's also home to the UK's biggest outdoor ice rink, a giant observation wheel and top Winter Wonderland Christmas shows. • You have booked tickets for entry at 2pm Head back to your accommodation in the evening, have dinner around (check eating out guide)
Day 3 Dec 30 Monday	Visit the Tower of London (25 mins by public transport) • Open 9am-5:30pm. • You have already booked tickets for 12 pm entry. • People typically spend 2 hours Walk across the Tower Bridge- 4 min walk from Tower of London • You can also time to be there when the bridge opens for a ship to pass. • Tower Bridge (free to walk across/view bridge opening) but if you want to visit the skywalk/glass level or the inner rooms, a ticket needs to be bought in advance here Spend time at Winter by the River at London Bridge City (7 min walk from Tower Bridge) • The setting is offering wooden huts packed with original presents, handmade crafts and plenty of delicious snacks Head to Borough market (7 min walk) for strawberries and chocolate and other treats!
Day 4 Dec 31 Tuesday	Visit London Eye (17 min by public transport)- tickets booked for 10:45 am. Then walk to the rest of the Westminster attractions- Westminster Abbey, Palace of Westminster, Big Ben. Visit Covent Garden (16 mins by public transport) to witness the festive decorations Head to the Seven Dials market for lunch. After sunset, stroll through Regents street/Bond Street/Oxford street to witness the iconic Christmas lighting

	Head back home and bring in the New Years together!
Day 5 Jan 1 Wednesday	Head to Sky Garden (20 mins by public transport) for lunch. The free viewing tickets are not available. Alternatively, you can try to get tickets to Horizon 22 (25 mins by public transport) Online tickets to Horizon 22 are also all fully booked but limited walk-in tickets are available at the entrance from 10 am everyday. Head to Regents Park for a relaxing and leisurely afternoon stroll. Visit the Camden Food Market for dinner Head back to the accommodation for the night.
Day 6 Jan 2 Thursday	Take a day trip to Hertfordshire/Hatfield You can visit the Hertford Castle (10 min bus ride from Hertford North station) And spend time walking around the Harthom Common park You could also directly take a train to Hatfield and visit the Bocket Hall which served as the Netherfield ballroom in the famous 1995 TV adaptation, and it was there the world was first introduced to Colin Firth's brooding Mr Darcy. You can also visit the Hatfield House, Parks and Gardens which was featured in <i>Shakespeare in Love</i> OR Take a day trip to the Cotswolds and visit Bibury, Bourton-on-the-water and Stratford Upon Avon (Shakespeare's birth place)
Day 7 Jan 3 Friday	Visit St. Paul's Cathedral (20 min travel by bus) - Open 8am-4:30 pm - People typically spend 30 mins Walk over London Bridge (15 min walk). Visit the Natural History Museum - Open 10am- 5:50 pm - People typically spend 4-5 hours. Free Booking OR Take a Lords Stadium Tour Book in advance Keep the evening free to have your son's friends over

Day 8 Jan 4 Saturday	Visit a Gurudwara in the morning - You can visit the UK's oldest established Gurudwara in Central London- Khalsa Jatha (45 mins by public transport) or the Sri Guru Singh Sabha in Southall (1h5m by public transport) Spend the afternoon walking through Regents canal. - Starting in Little Venice and finishing on the River Thames, this 9-mile walk along the length of Regent's Canal is one of London's best-kept secrets. Keep the evening free to have your son's friends over
Day 9 Jan 5 Sunday	Travel to Oxford (1.5 hr drive). It is recommended to use one of the following four Park & Rides conveniently located on the outskirts of Oxford. You have booked a tour that covers the University and top sights around the city. The tour will start at 2 pm Return back to London for the night
Day 10 Jan 6 Monday	Travel to Cambridge (1.5 hr drive). Please refer to this link for the relevant car parks You have booked a 90 min shared walking tour followed by access to Kings College Chapel. The tour will start at 2pm. Following your tour, you can choose to visit any of the following- Fitzwilliam Museum- houses a vast collection of antiquities and art, with one of the greatest catalogues in Europe. Whipple Museum of the History of Science: This fascinating museum is relatively small and quick to cover, Cambridge University Botanic Garden- This beautiful garden offers a peaceful escape City centre- The main shopping areas and streets with historic buildings Return back to London for the night
Day 11 Jan 7	Keep the day free for convocation prep and shopping

Tuesday	
Day 12 Jan 8 Wednesday	Convocation Day Congratulations to all of you!
Day 13 Jan 9 Thursday	Spend the morning at Mercato Metropolitano or Spitalfields Watch the Lion Kings Musical at 7 pm Head to Chinatown for dinner
Day 14 Jan 10 Friday	Keep the day free for shopping and quality family time!
Day 15 Jan 11 Saturday	Catch your flight back to India

Where to Eat in London

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Timings	Comments
Mercato Metropolitano	Food market with various, multicuisine food stalls	Manuelina Focacceria- for fresh focaccia; Fiordilatte & Friends for cheese Tortellino & Co. for pasta Badiani for gelato The Italian Job-craft beers and wine	12 pm – 1 am	Very close to your accommodation (3min walk)
Kebab Addiction Turkish cuisine	Turkish	Doner kebabs	11:30 am – 12 am	5 min walk from your accommodation
Duke of York	Pub	British pub grub	11 am – 11 pm	6 min walk from your accommodation
Costa Azul	Ecuadorian	Seafood	12pm- 6 pm	4 min walk from your accommodation
Covent Garden-Seven Dials market	Several restaurants		12pm-10pm	Option for lunch on Dec 31st

China Town	Colourful area with many chinese eateries	Dumplings and noodles, sitrfrys	Most eateries are open from 11am- 11pm	Option after the musical
Vicinity	Global	Cocktails, afternoon tea	12pm-11pm	Near Katherine docks and tower bridge, on the banks of Thames
Zizi- St. Katherine Docks	Italian	Pizzas and calzones Veg options	11:30 am- 10 pm	Near Katherine docks and tower bridge
Emilia's crafted pasta	Italian	Pasta, veg options	12pm-9:30 pm	Near Katherine docks and tower bridge
Camden Market	Food market with various, multicusine food stalls	Pizzas from Purezza, Asian from Mildreds, What the pitta-Mediterranean	10am-6pm	Option if visiting Regents Park
Bourough Market	Food market with various, multicusine food stalls	Strawberries with chocolate, Fresh cheese at Bath Cheese Shop	Closed on mon Tues- fri- 10am-5pm Sat 9am-5pm Sun 10am-4pm	

Famous Dishes in England

- **Pasty's**- This baked shell of pastry with a variety of ingredients inside is a super tasty lunch snack that comes from Cornwall in the South West. The traditional Cornish Pasty contains meat- but there are many veg versions.
- **Fish and Chips**- This classic combination of breaded fish and fried potatoes has been made popular around the world, but it originated in England.
- **Shepherds pie**- Made with lamb and topped with mashed potatoes, shepherd's pie is a hearty dish that is popular throughout the United Kingdom.
- **Sunday Roast**- Roast chicken
- **Bubble and Squeak** is a mix of cooked potatoes, cabbage, and occasionally other ingredients since it's a common dish made from leftovers and offcuts of veg from other dishes. The ingredients are all mixed together and fried.
- **Yorkshire Pudding** is a traditional food from Yorkshire made from eggs, flour, and milk, and it's often found as a side dish in a Sunday Roast or other pub foods. It's best served with gravy, and you may need to specify that you'd like onion gravy instead of meat-based gravy.
- **Victoria Sponge** is simple but glorious! With vanilla sponge sandwiching a jam and buttercream (or whipped cream) filling, this is a light, fluffy, and seriously tasty dessert that's typically vegetarian.
- **Crumpets**- these are small spongy, cake-like treats made from unsweetened batter, and you would usually have them at breakfast, at afternoon tea, or as a sweet snack after a meal.
- **Parkin** hails from Yorkshire in the north and is a traditional ginger cake made from molasses, oatmeal, and spices. It is sticky, chewy and sweet
- **Cheese and Pickle Sandwich**- If you're looking for a traditional English lunch food that's vegetarian, you can't go wrong with a Cheese and Pickle Sandwich.
- **Onion Rings** originated in England, and they're found as a side on many menus all over the country
- **Bread and Butter Pudding** is a traditional pudding in England that's made from slices of buttered bread, and raisins, and covered in an egg custard mixture containing nutmeg or vanilla. The whole thing is baked to make a lovely sweet dessert that's popular in England.
- **Stilton** is another English cheese that's incredibly flavourful. It's made from cow's milk, has a blueish-green mould on the surface, and has a strong flavour
- **Sticky Toffee Pudding** is an English dessert made of moist sponge cake flavoured with dates, and covered in toffee sauce. You'll usually be offered it with custard or vanilla ice cream
- **Cauliflower Cheese**- florets of boiled cauliflower covered in a milk-based cheese sauce and baked in the oven so it's gooey underneath and a little crispy on top. Delicious, and vegetarian.
- **Scones**- They're sweet and often eaten with jam and cream as part of a cream tea or afternoon tea in England
- **Mushy peas** are prepared by boiling marrowfat peas with soda bicarbonate, resulting in a thick pea soup.

- **Beans on toast** is a classic, straightforward dish often associated with British cuisine but enjoyed worldwide.
- **Trifle**- A traditional English trifle has layers of fruit, cream, and cake to make an eye-catching dessert.
- **Eatons mess**- meringue, cream and fruit.

Mobile Connectivity while in UK

- There are many SIM Card providers in the UK.
- **I would recommend Three**
- The best place to buy a sim card is at the airport kiosks
- Even if you do not purchase an international roaming plan for your current India number, remember to activate roaming so that you receive messages (important for things like OTPs).

Important Numbers in UK

Here are few numbers you may need while in UK

- 999- Emergency services
- 101- Police Non Emergency Number
- 111- NHS Emergency number (24/7)

Embassy Info- UK

London- In case of emergency, contact 00 44 (0)7768765035

Edinburgh- +44 131 229 2144

Important Places Around Your Accommodation

London

Convenience stores

[Sainsburys](#) (7 min walk)- open 6 am -11 pm

Hospital

[St Thomas Hospital](#) (8 min by taxi)

Pharmacy

[St George's Pharmacy](#) (6 min walk)

Recommended things to buy/carry

- Travel Insurance-. Recommendation- TATA AIG
- Umbrellas
- Jackets (for rain and the cold)
- Layers in terms of clothing
- Travel adaptors- Type F plug adaptor for Turkey and Type G plug adaptor for UK
- Doctors prescriptions/travel prescriptions for medicines (except over the counter meds)
- Walking shoes!
- Portable chargers (as you will be on the move for most of the time)
- Forex (cash and cards)

Recommended Apps

- Google Translate
- Google Maps
- Get your guide (for your bookings)

Regarding Foreign Currency- UK

- GBP (Great Britain Pound) is the currency used in the UK
- Carry a forex card to avoid transaction costs that are usually charged on your international credit card.
- While most establishments (hotels, bigger restaurants will accept cards, it's a good idea to carry cash for small purchases. Things like public restrooms, or using a cart at the supermarket even need coins!
- Exchange money before going and if you need some additional cash while there, the most cost effective way is to use an ATM. Do check with your banks regarding the charges.
- Ensure that the international debit/credit cards you are carrying are activated for international spends.
- If you decide not to use the Oyster card for your travel within London, then do ensure that each of you are carrying a card of some sort, that you will have to tap while entering and exiting the tube stations and the buses-. In London, they no longer have the possibility of purchasing printed tickets, and you cannot tap/swipe the same card for more than 1 traveller.

Getting Around in London

The cheapest way to travel around London on the bus, Tube, tram, DLR, London Overground and most National Rail services is to use an Oyster card, a smartcard ticket.

You can purchase an Oyster Card at Kings Cross St, Pancras. They are also for sale from Underground ticket machines, Oyster ticket stops (a series of businesses around London, see [Oyster map](#) here for nearest location), London Overground ticket offices, train station ticket offices, and London Transport Visitor Centres.

You pay a £7 refundable deposit to get an Oyster card. you can top up your credit online.

You can get a Young Adult discount (half adult rate for children between 11-15 years) added to an Oyster card at Heathrow Airport Terminals stations, most Tube stations and [TfL Visitor and Travel Information Centres](#).

If at all you need a taxi, book an Uber.

What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

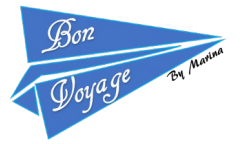
Type of souvenir	Where to buy
Tea	London Fortnum and Mason Supermarkets all across UK
London Dry Gin	Supermarkets across London
Cadbury Chocolate	Supermarkets across UK
Fresh Cheese	London Borough market , Supermarkets across UK
Tunnock's Tea cakes	Supermarkets all across the UK
Shortbread	Supermarkets all across the UK
Sticky Toffee Pudding	Supermarkets all across the UK
Colognes and perfumes	Jo Malone's Regent Street
Typical souvenirs like magnets, bottle openers with images like the double decker bus, Buckingham palace guards, Paddington bear, Big Ben, London eye, Lake district pictures, Cotswold cottages, Scottish Highlands, Edinburgh Castle, Loch Ness	Souvenir shops all across
Harry Potter Merchandise	Harry Potter stores at Kings cross and Covent Garden, London
Football accessories	New Oxford Street
Beatles memorabilia	London Beatles Store

Thank You!

Thank you for trusting us with the opportunity to plan your vacation!

We hope your trip is filled with unforgettable memories and special moments together.

Remember, we're always here to assist you—before, during, and even after your journey. Just a call or message away!



Bon Voyage By Marina - 86000-15316